

some nice tongue in cheek moments like with naming your gaming app 'Play Games'. Most of us know this one as the sometimes annoying pop-up that (heh) pops up whenever we launch a game on our phones or tablets. Google Play Games is a social gaming service which has features like leaderboards and rankings and enables things like multiplayer games over WLAN. It's also a software development kit which allows game devs to basically use Google's code to integrate all the features into their games without having to develop the code for it themselves. It was first released in 2013 and has had features steadily added to it, like the ability to sync your saved games to the cloud as well as recording your on-screen gameplay for sharing.

Play Books

Now we enter the realm of perfectly good yet rarely used apps. If stock Android had bloatware, it would probably be these apps by Google which sit in an unobtrusive folder, never being clicked on or even opened. And that's a damn shame, especially for Play Books. Like the name implies, Play Books is an ebook reader with its own distribution system and marketplace built in, à la Kindle. Users can choose over five million titles from the store or upload their own books (upto a thousand) to the cloud, which automatically gets synced across all your devices; which you can then read on Chrome, or pretty much any other browser or the dedicated Play Books apps. Originally released as Google eBooks, it has gone through several revisions and upgrades since it's launch in 2010. Several new page layout styles and colours have been added and since it supports the .epub format, books work across different screen sizes. It's a lightweight and clean app that unfortunately falls flat due to a couple of reasons – you can't read books without uploading them to the cloud first, meaning it doesn't detect books on local storage. The purchasing infrastructure and other general features, while decent, can't match its main competitor, the Kindle's, finesse. Nevertheless, it's a great app for those who love reading.

Play Movies & TV

It seems like most of the Play apps have fierce competition – Game Center vs Play Games (but in this case, both aren't really that great), Kindle vs Play Books, Spotify vs Play Music... you get the drift. But there is one app that specifically has so much competition that it's not even funny. Google's stab at the on demand video streaming service niche gave birth to the Play Movies and TV service, back in 2012. Just for comparison, Netflix was